

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Wednesday, September 23, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



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National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations:

- No new significant incidents/operations

Disaster Declaration Activity:

- No new declaration activity

Hazard Monitoring:

- Excessive Rainfall/Flash Flooding – New Mexico to Central Plains, Tennessee to Ohio Valley
- Tropical Activity:
 - Atlantic:
 - Disturbance 1: Med (40%)
 - Disturbance 2: Low (20%)
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Hurricane Polo (CAT-4)
 - Hurricane Odalys (CAT-1)
 - Tropical Depression Fifteen-E
 - Disturbance 1: High (80%)

Event Monitoring:

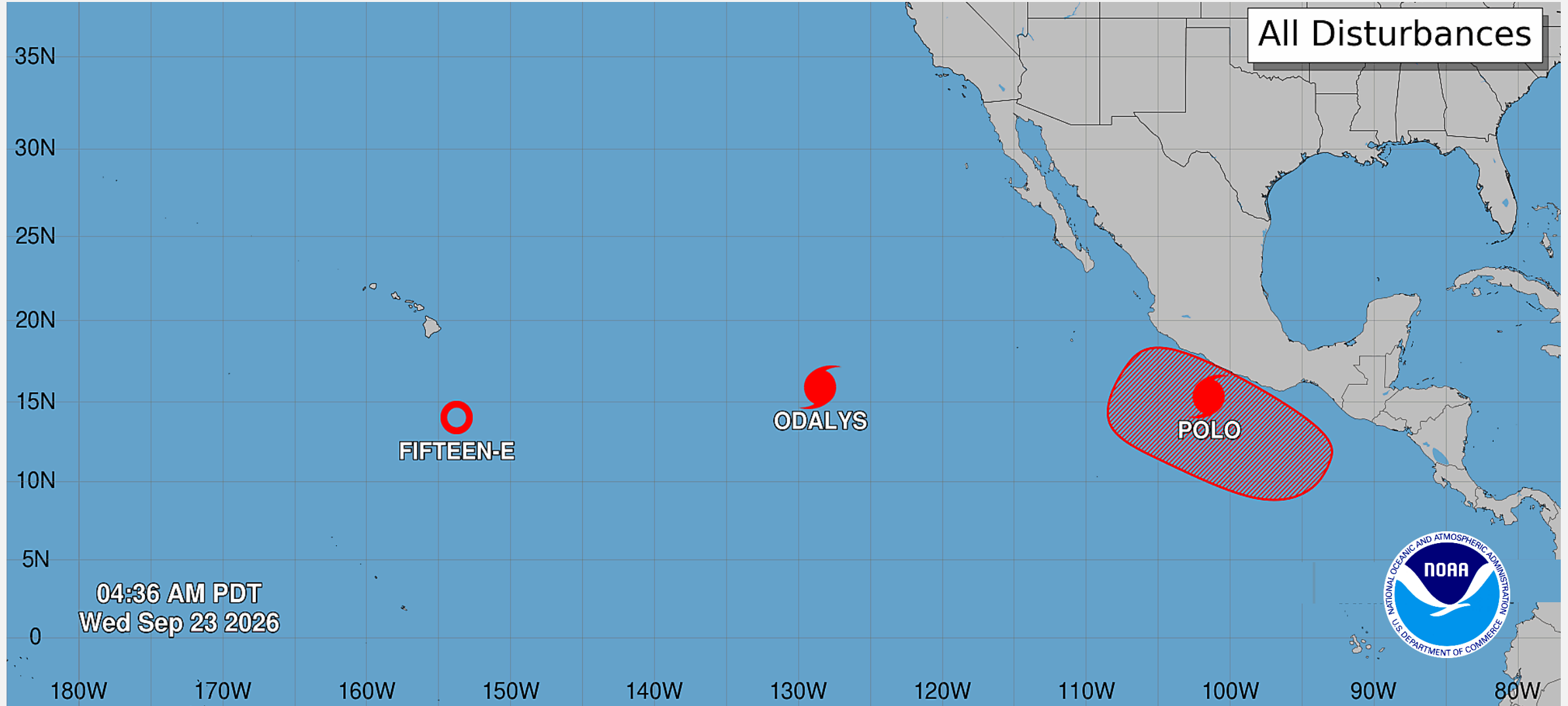
- 81st United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) – New York, NY



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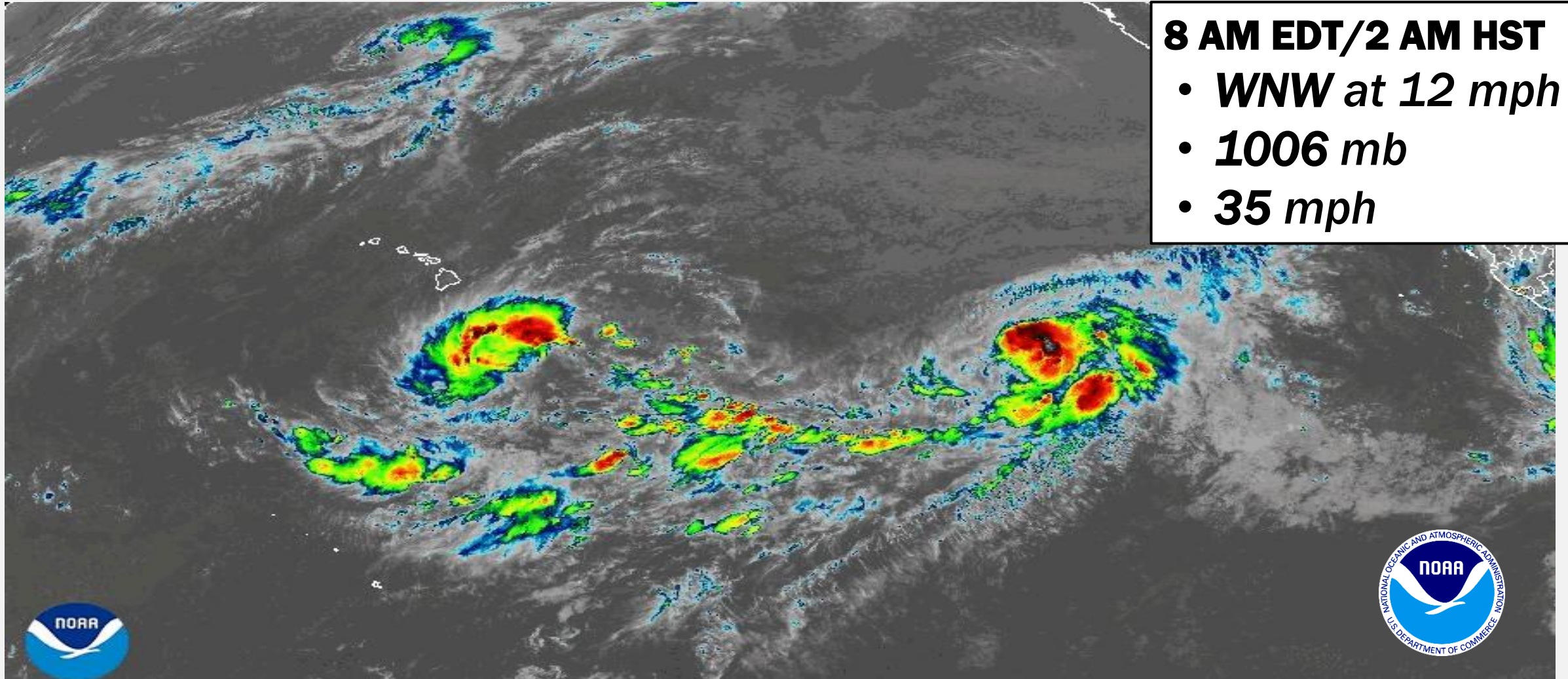
Central and East Pacific Overview

TROPICAL OUTLOOK



Tropical Depression 15E

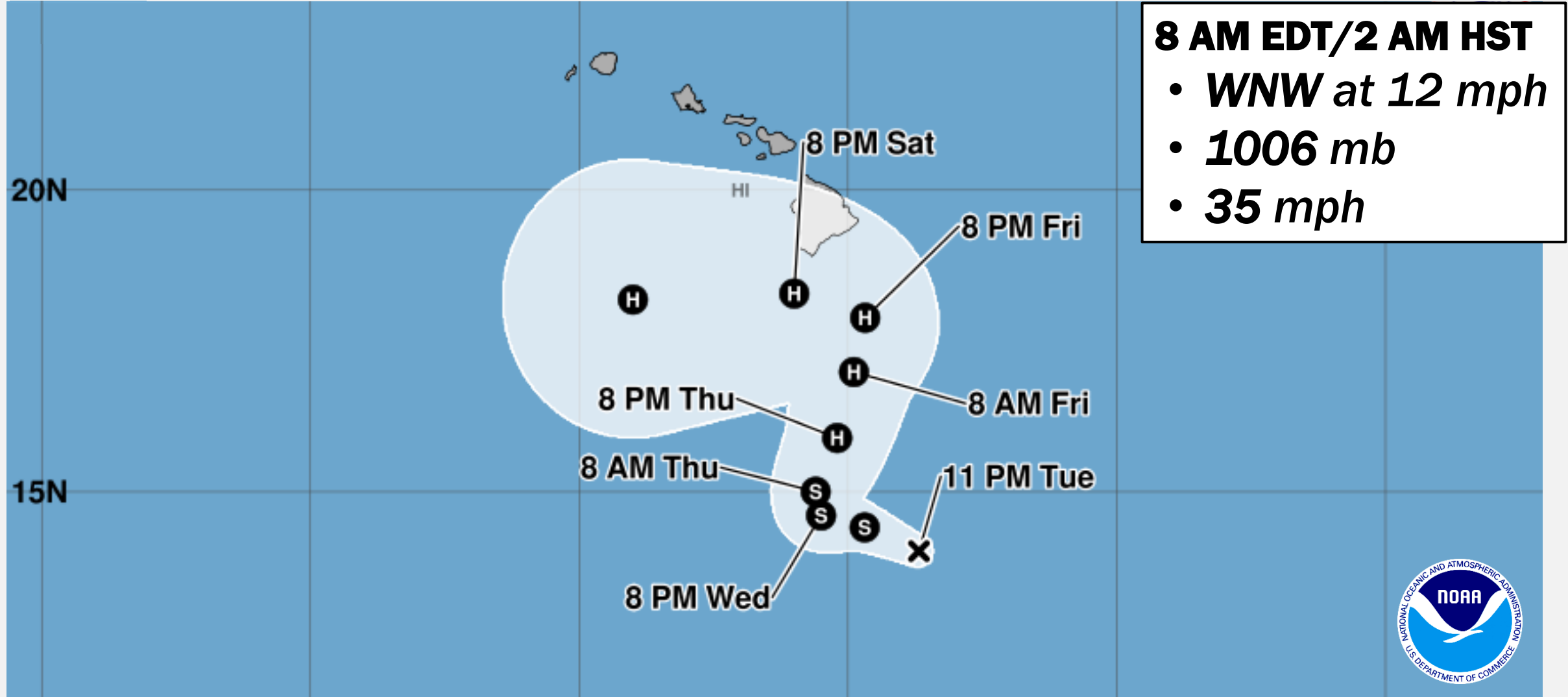
SATELLITE LOOP



23 Sep 2026 03:40Z - NOAA/NESDIS/STAR - GOES-West - Band 13

Tropical Depression 15E

FORECAST TRACK

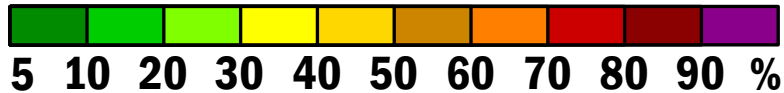


Tropical Depression 15E

MOST LIKELY ARRIVAL OF TROPICAL STORM WINDS

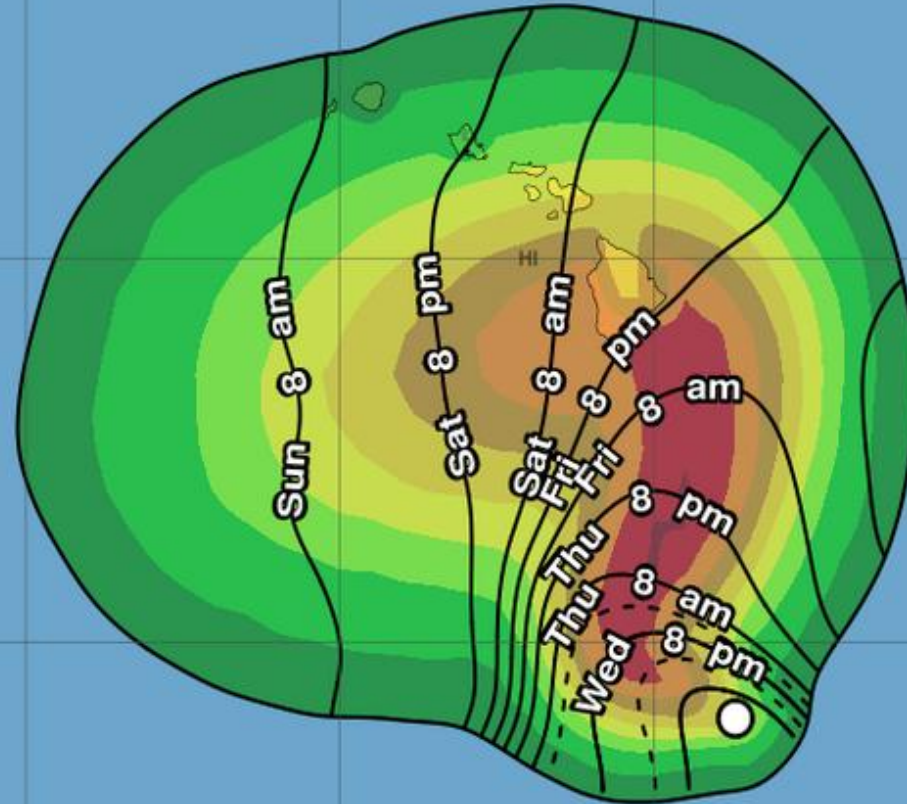
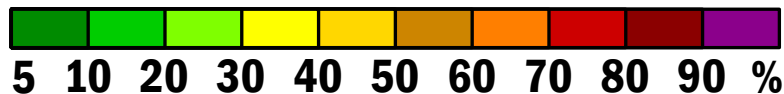
TS Wind Probabilities

South Point, HI	78%
Hilo, HI	71%
Kailua-Kona, HI	68%
Lanai City, HI	33%
Honolulu, HI	19%



Hurricane Wind Probabilities

South Point, HI	23%
Hilo, HI	14%
Kailua-Kona, HI	12%



All Times HST

Tropical Depression 15E

Flood Hazard Outlook/Rainfall



Flood Hazard Outlook (Experimental): Tropical Depression Fifteen-E

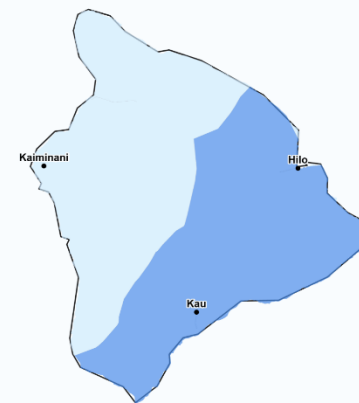
Issued 09-23-2026 07:00 AM CDT

Valid through 09-30-2026 07:00 AM CDT — Next Issuance: 09-23-2026 03:00 PM CDT

Flood Hazard Messages

Hawaii

- Considerable flash flooding will be possible across eastern portions of the Big Island beginning today and continuing into the weekend.
- Locally considerable flash flooding will be possible across the remainder of the Big Island, as well as Maui County.
- Mudslides are also possible in areas of steep terrain.



50 mi

Potential Flooding Impacts

- Catastrophic
- Considerable
- Limited

Disclaimer: This 7-day outlook provides an overview of potential flash, river and tidal flood hazards. Please refer to detailed products issued by local National Weather Service offices for official forecasts and warnings. (www.weather.gov)



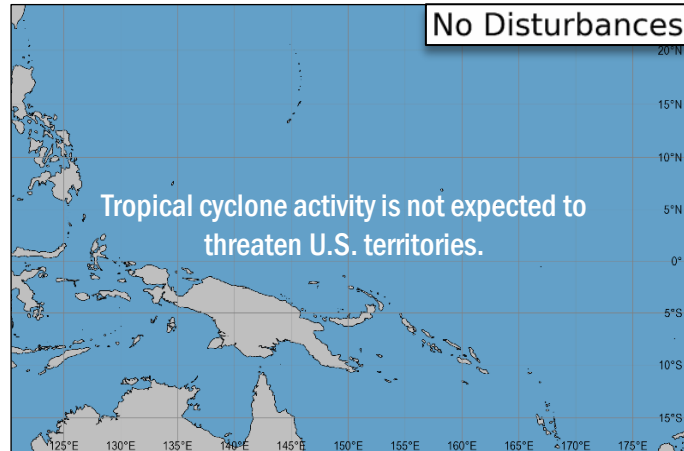
National Oceanic and
Atmospheric Administration
U.S. Department of Commerce

To learn more or provide feedback, visit:
www.weather.gov/owp/operations

NWC
National
Water
Center

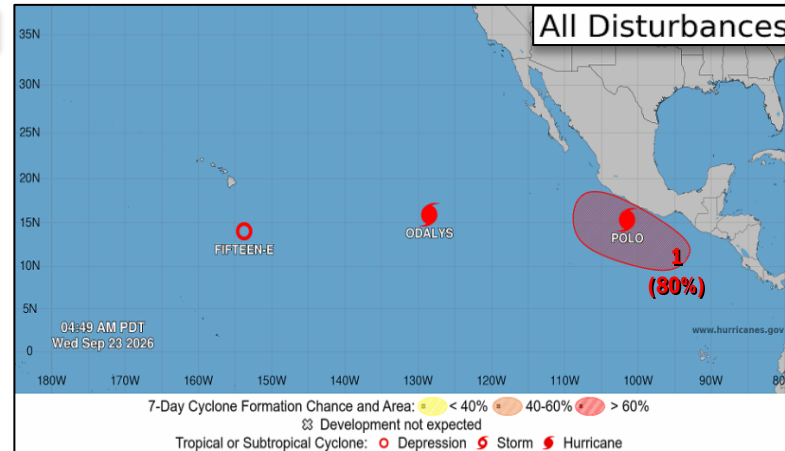
Tropical Outlook

Western Pacific



- Tropical cyclone activity is not expected to threaten U.S. territories.

Eastern and Central Pacific



Hurricane Polo (CAT-4): (Advisory #11A, as of 7:00 a.m. ET)

- See following slide

Hurricane Odalys (CAT-1): (Advisory #13, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See following slide

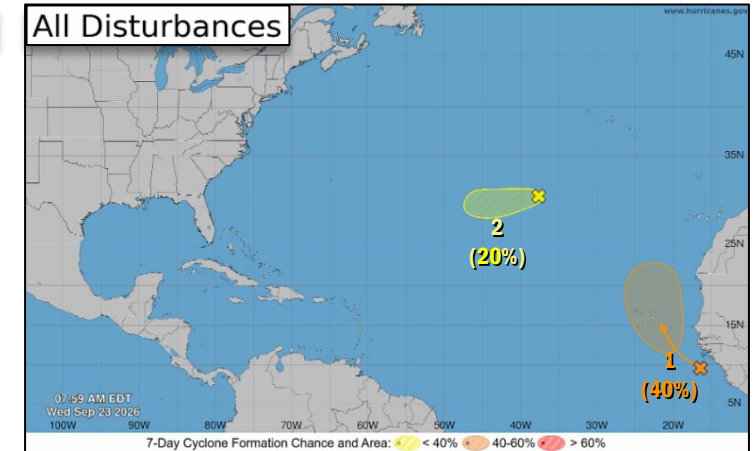
Tropical Depression Fifteen-E: (Advisory #11, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- See following slide

Disturbance 1: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located S of the Gulf of Tehuantepec
- Environmental conditions appear favorable for gradual development; a tropical depression is likely to form late this weekend
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (near 0%); 7-day: High (80%)

Atlantic



Disturbance 1: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Tropical wave located 600 mi SE of the Cabo Verde Islands
- Expected to form in a day or so, and it could become a short-lived tropical depression tomorrow or Friday
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (30%); 7-day: Medium (40%)

Disturbance 2: (as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Low pressure system located about 800 mi SW of the Azores
- Significant redevelopment of this system is unlikely
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (20%); 7-day: Low (20%)



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Hurricane Polo (CAT-4) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: *(Advisory #11A, as of 7:00 a.m. ET)*

- Located **165** miles SE of Manzanillo, Mexico
- Moving N at 2 mph
- A sharp turn to the northwest is expected to begin later today followed by a general west-northwestward motion later this week and over the weekend
- Maximum sustained winds of **150** mph
- Hurricane-force winds extend up to 40 miles from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend up to 105 miles from center
- Intensity expected to fluctuate although the storm will remain strong



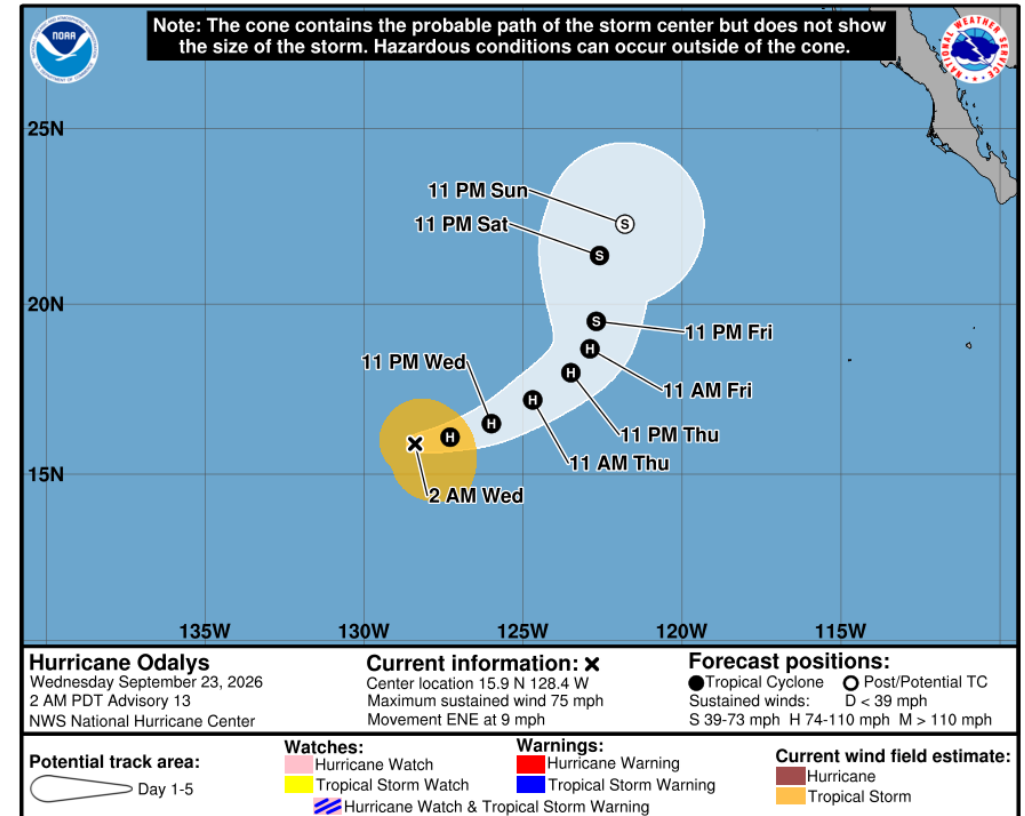
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Hurricane Odalys (CAT-1) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #13, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

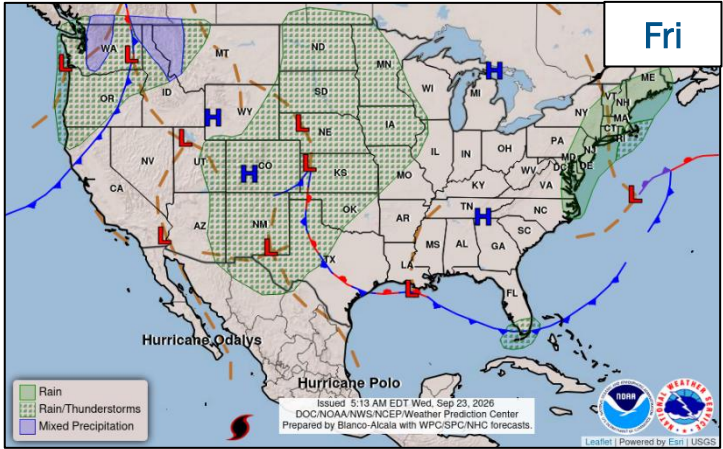
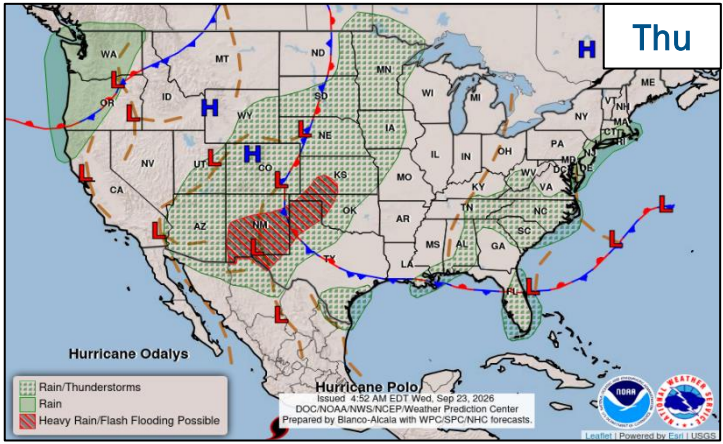
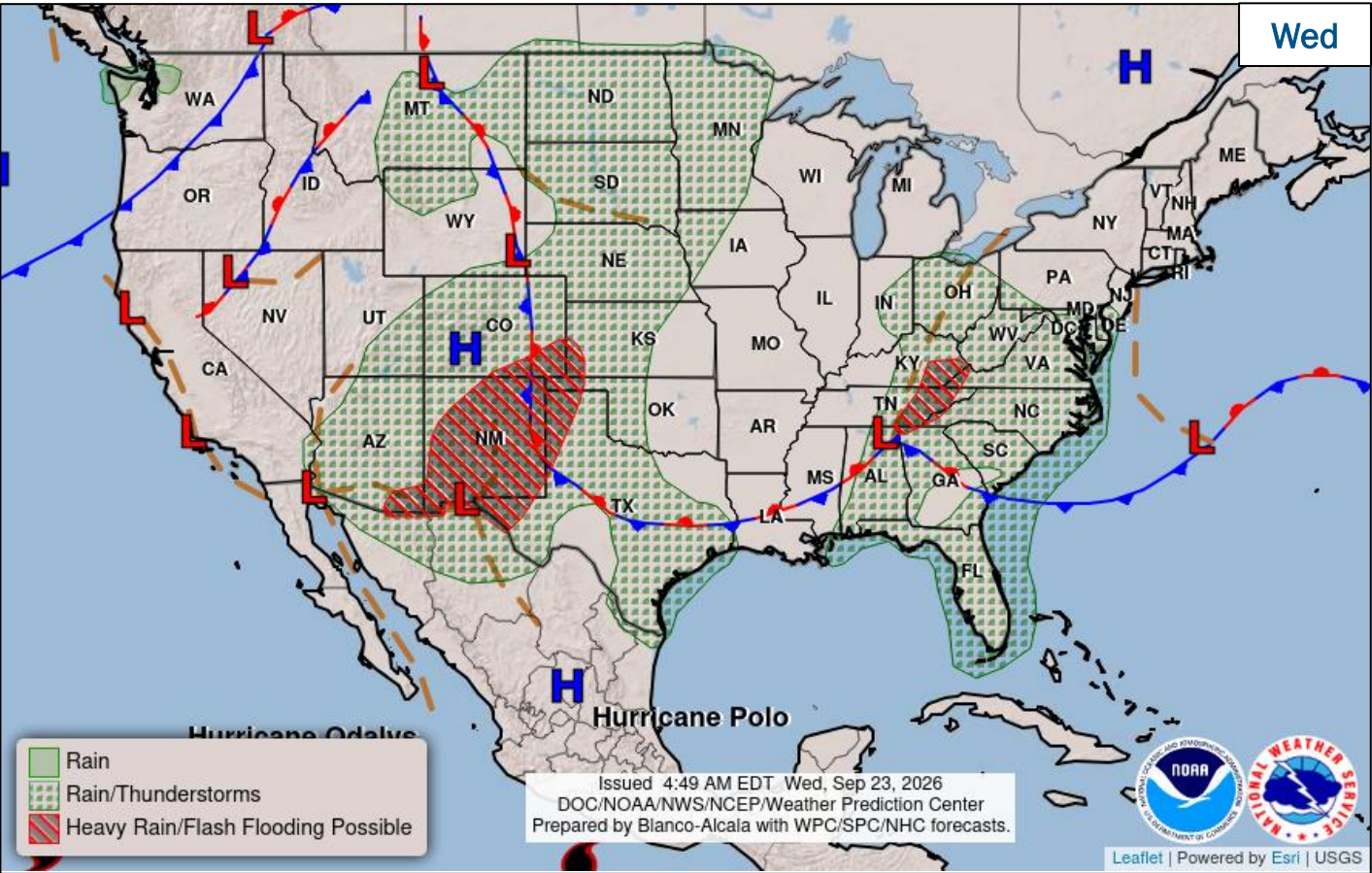
- Located **1,295** miles **WSW** of the southern tip of Baja California
- Moving **ENE** at **9** mph
- Maximum sustained winds **75** mph
- **Hurricane force winds extend 10 mi from center**
- Tropical-storm-force winds extend **150** miles from center
- **Additional strengthening is expected during the next day or two**



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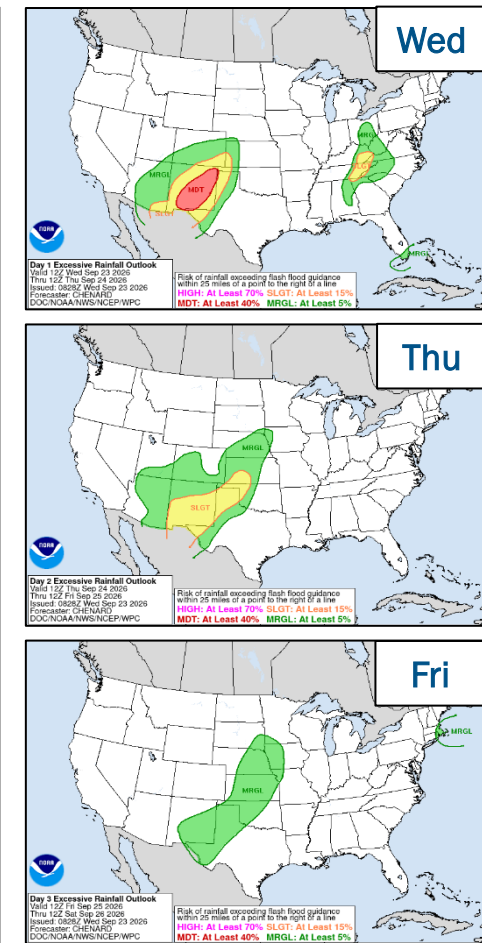
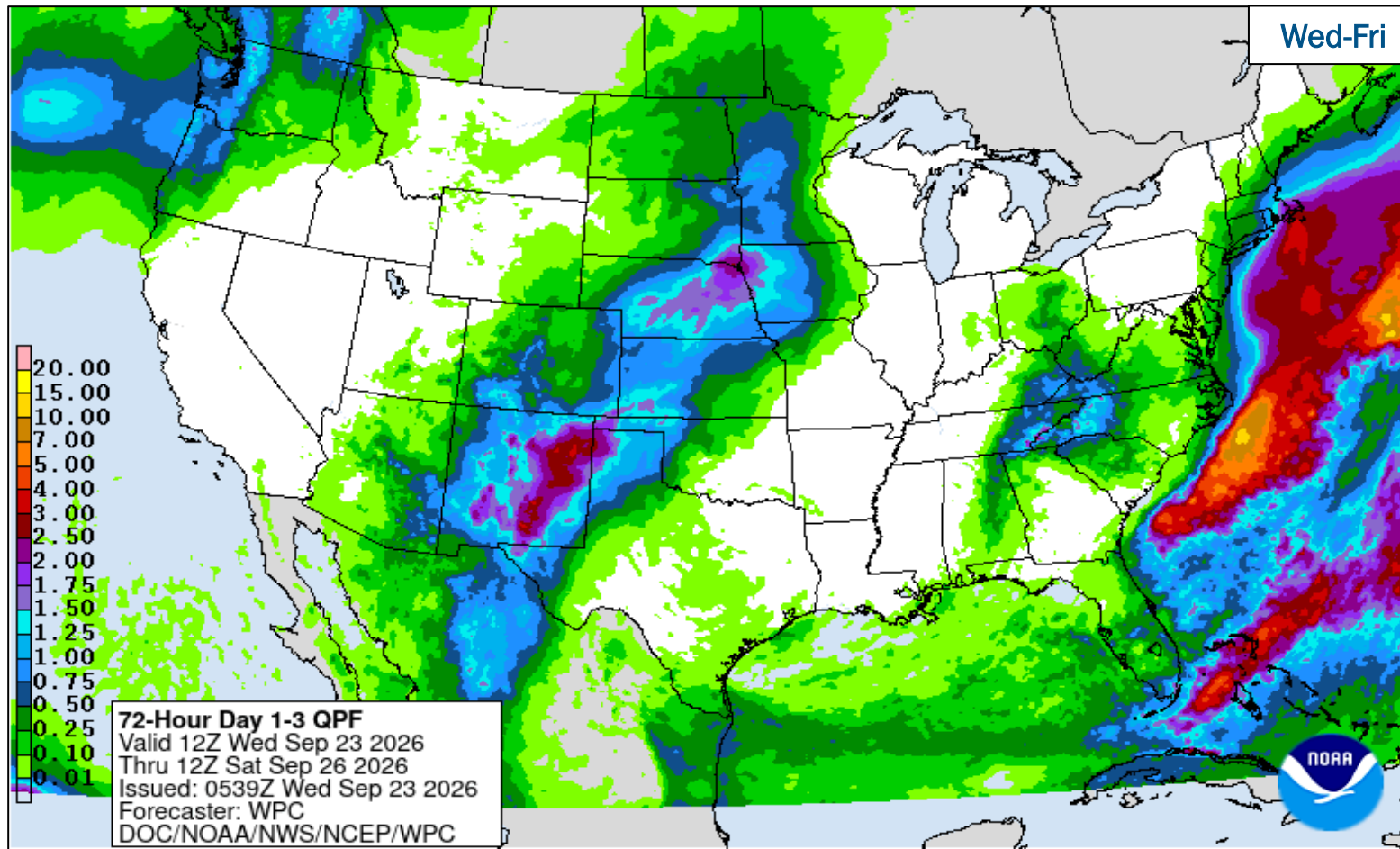
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National Weather Forecast



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Precipitation & Excessive Rainfall



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INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (88 fires)
New Large Fires	1
Large Fires Contained	1
Uncontained Large Fires	31
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,554,955
Total Responders	9,701
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	6
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	63
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed



Wildfire Summary

Fire Name (County, ST)	FMAG #	Acres Burned	Percent Contained	Evacuations	Structures (Homes / Other)			Fatalities / Injuries
					Threatened	Damaged	Destroyed	
Sand Creek (Beaverhead, MT) FINAL	5671-FM-MT	35,520	76% (+5)	LIFTED	H: 42	H: 0	H: 0	0 / 8
					O: 0	O: 0	O: 4	

Structures: H = Homes and Mixed Commercial/Residential / O = Non-residential Commercial/Other Minor Structures)



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FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,891
Assigned a Disaster Title

6,037 / 32%
Deployed

6,411 / 34%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,443 / 34%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,697 / 0 / 769
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Wednesday
September 23, 2026
8:30 a.m. ET

National Readiness

National Watch Center

NRCC

N-IMAT Red

N-IMAT White

N-IMAT Blue

N-IMAT Gold

N-IMAT HS

National Notes

National Watch Center:
• Staffing

NRCC:
• Rostered

National IMATs:
• N-IMAT Red: Reconstituting 9/25
• N-IMAT White: Staffing
• N-IMAT Blue: Staffing
• N-IMAT HS: UNGA

REGIONAL BREAKDOWN

	JFO	DR	EM	JRO
R1	0	1	0	0
R2	0	0	0	2
R3	0	2	0	0
R4	3	10	0	1
R5	0	3	0	0
R6	4	7	3	3
R7	0	9	0	0
R8	0	9	0	0
R9	0	6	6	0
R10	4	7	1	0



CNMI
DR-4910-MP &
EM-3647-MP
• R9 IMAT-2

Guam
DR-4921-GU &
EM-3648-GU
• ISB Delta

Flooding
Impacts Poss.
Fifteen-E
Hawaii

Hawaiian Islands
DR-4936-HI, DR-4909-HI
& EM-3652-HI
• R9 IMAT-1

TC Odalys
Fifteen-E
TC Polo
Dist. 2

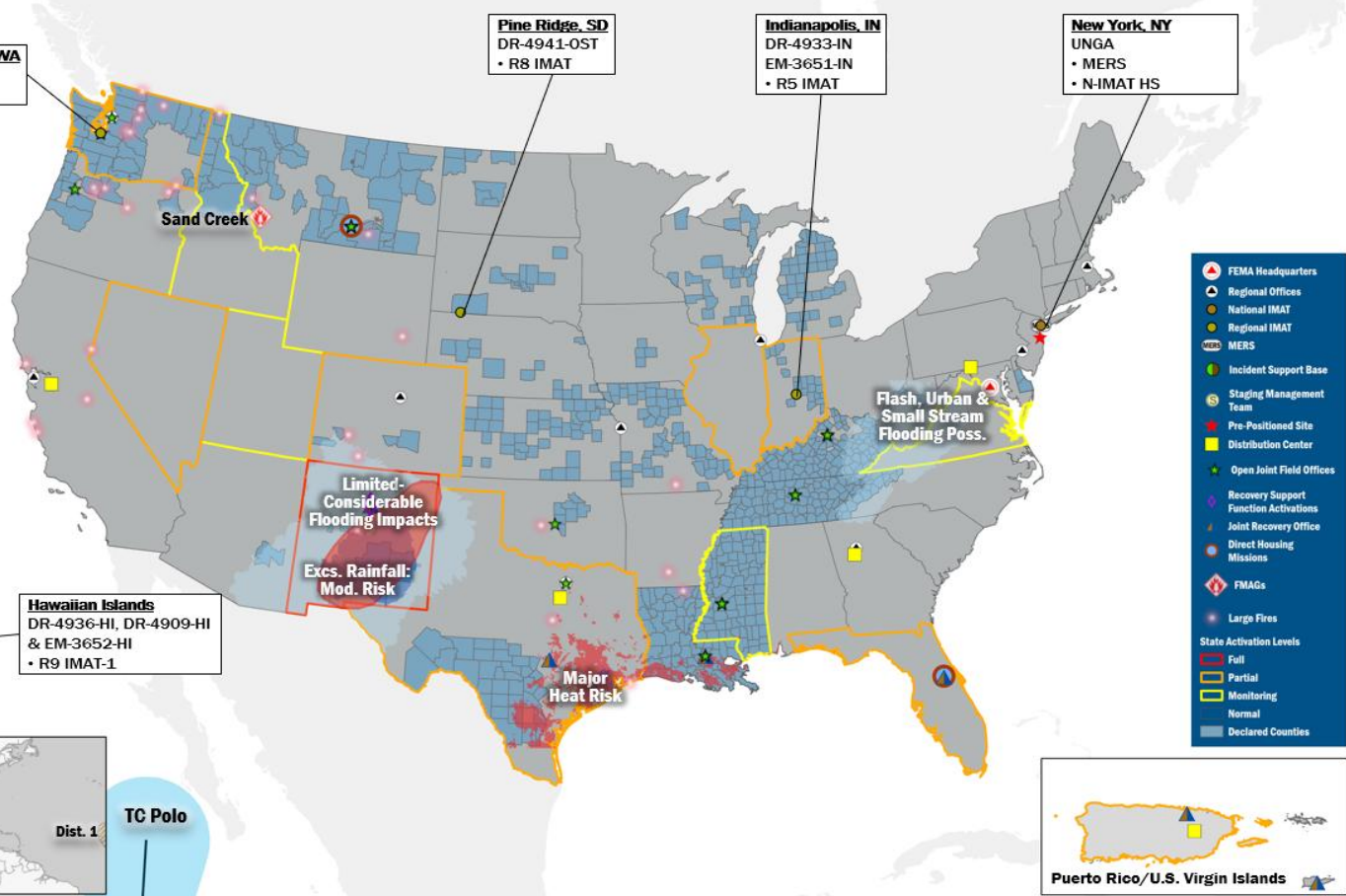
TC Polo
Dist. 1

Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

Pine Ridge, SD
DR-4941-OST
• R8 IMAT

Indianapolis, IN
DR-4933-IN
EM-3651-IN
• R5 IMAT

New York, NY
UNGA
• MERS
• N-IMAT HS



- FEMA Headquarters
- Regional Offices
- National IMAT
- Regional IMAT
- MERS
- Incident Support Base
- Staging Management Team
- Pre-Positioned Site
- Distribution Center
- Open Joint Field Offices
- Recovery Support Function Activations
- Joint Recovery Office
- Direct Housing Missions
- FMAGs
- Large Fires
- State Activation Levels
- Full
- Partial
- Monitoring
- Normal
- Declared Counties



Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1

Region 2

Region 3

Region 4

Region 5

Region 6

Region 7

Region 8

Region 9

Region 10

Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:
• R2 Watch: Equipment
• R5 Watch: Staffing
• R2 RRCC: UNGA
• R10 RRCC: Staffing

State EOCs:
• FL/MS: Previous Incidents
• AK/AR/CO/ID/NV/TX/UT/WA: Wildfires
• IL/KY: Severe Weather
• NM: Excessive Rainfall
• MP: TC Bavi/Saudel
• PR/VA: Drought
• IN: 4933-DR-IN/3651-EM-IN
• HI: TC Lowell

IMATs:
• R1: Staffing
• R3: Staffing
• R4-1/2: Staffing
• R5: 3651-EM-IN
• R7: Staffing
• R8: 4941-DR-OST
• R9-1: 3652-EM-HI/4909-DR-HI/4936-DR-HI
• R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
• R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

- Fully Mission Capable
- Partially Mission Capable
- Requires Augmentation
- Deployed/Activated

Commodities & Equipment

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

SMT

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	0/11

MERS Det.

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

US&R

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	0
FEMA-Deployed	0
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	28
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

FCO

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	1
Deployed	29 (29 FCOR)
Available	8

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R10	AK	Mukluk Fire Aug 21-25	IA	1	0	9/21 – TBD
			PA	1	0	9/21 – TBD



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Declaration Requests in Process – 16

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
NE – Severe Storm, Straight-line Winds, and Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X		X	Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2
TN – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lala	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lowell	DR	X	X	X	Sep 9
WV – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Sep 12
IL – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 15
KS – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 15



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Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



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